

SpotDrop

Proximity-based social music discovery for Spotify

Full PM case study: Discovery | PRD | Roadmap | Design | GTM | Post-Launch Analysis

Mayank Pandey

M.S. Engineering Management
University of Southern California

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THE PROBLEM

Millions of commuters are surrounded by others daily yet feel isolated. Music is playing everywhere but there is no way to discover what the person next to you is listening to without a conversation starter.

THE SOLUTION

SpotDrop adds an opt-in proximity layer to Spotify. Users see what nearby people are listening to in real time, browse anonymously, and send a non-verbal listen-together request without leaving the app.

CORE FEATURES

Nearby Listening Feed

Real-time view of what people around you are playing, with distance

Privacy Toggle and Anonymous Mode

Full control over visibility in one tap

Save to Library

Save any nearby song to Spotify library instantly

Jam Request

Non-verbal listen-together invite with accept or decline

Ephemeral Chat and Reactions

Short messages and emoji during a session, clears on exit

AI Icebreakers

Song-aware conversation starters via the sparkle button

PRODUCT ROADMAP

NOW (0 to 6 mo)	Feed, toggle, save, jam request, offline
NEXT (6 to 12 mo)	Reactions, chat, AI tools, gamification
LATER (12 mo+)	Group jams, events, cross-platform

KEY SUCCESS METRICS

15%	40%	500k
DAU adoption (3 mo)	Jam acceptance rate	Daily jams (month 6)

HYPOTHETICAL PILOT RESULTS (Month 3)

Metric	Target	Actual	vs.
Feature Adoption	15% DAU	12% DAU	Below
Jam Acceptance Rate	40%	38%	On Track
NPS Score	7.0	7.3	Above
Songs Saved / User	1 per 5 users	1.4 per 5	Above
Artist Diversity	20%	28%	Above
Retention Lift	+10%	+11%	Above

KEY INSIGHT

Discovery metrics exceeded all targets. The friction point is jam initiation, not acceptance. Users browse passively but hesitate to send the first request. The primary iteration focus is reducing send friction via UI testing and accelerating AI Icebreakers from the Next phase.

RESEARCH BASIS

Spotify Q4 2024 Earnings (675M MAU, 263M subscribers)
IFPI Engaging with Music 2023 (20.7 hrs/week, 26 markets, 43k respondents)
SiriusXM Media On-the-Go Report (24% of audio time in transit)
Apple Support and Pocket-lint for competitive analysis of SharePlay and Spotify Jam

PM SKILLS

User Research and Persona Development
RICE Feature Prioritization
PRD Writing with Acceptance Criteria
Now/Next/Later Roadmapping
GTM Strategy and Market Selection
Hypothesis-Driven Iteration Planning
Competitive Analysis
Design Thinking and Interaction Spec
Post-Launch Data Interpretation

DOCUMENTS

Phase 1: Discovery and Research
Phase 2a: Product Requirements Document
Phase 2b: Product Roadmap
Phase 2c: Design and Mockups (9 screens)
Phase 3: GTM Strategy and Post-Launch Analysis